whole saw the West with ‘half reluctant admiration, half volatile resentment’ as a result of ‘the tutelage of the British’.[31]

According to Indian strategic thinker K. Subrahmanyam, non-alignment was an attempt to balance Indian foreign policy in a world of superpower dominance. For Subrahmanyam, it was a ‘sound strategy in realpolitik sense and in terms of balance of power’.[32] According to Devdutt, Dixit and E. Malcolm House, non-alignment helped India achieve both ‘internal stability’ and ‘external security’ as it enabled India ‘to speak in one voice’ based on a positive consensus-driven policy.[33] Non-alignment also ensured that while India did not join either bloc, it maintained ties with both the camps and hence was able to obtain aid and technical assistance from both blocs, allowing it to build its resources without getting drawn into conflicts. According to Levi, following the policy of non-alignment enabled India to ‘retain greater freedom of action to play its leadership role in Asia’. [34]

Paul F. Power attempts to analyse Nehruvianism through two broad principles, order and strategy. The desire for order led Nehru to pursue friendship towards all states; champion anti-colonialism, anti-racialism and anti-imperialism; seek economic self-sufficiency; and oppose military alliances, arms build-up and nuclear weapons.[35] Non-alignment provided the underpinnings of strategy or as Power prefers to call it, an ‘independent’ policy. For Power, like Murty, non-alignment was a calculated response to the prevalent international situation. It was not just ‘an ad hoc response’ to the cold war. It reflected the desire to accomplish what Nehru had stated in a September 1946 speech: Stand up to the existing system of world affairs which was framed by imperialism, military alliances and war making and in its place create a world with no camps where all worked towards global peace and prosperity.[36]

Pursuing non-alignment ensured a domestic consensus on foreign policy that might not have been possible had India aligned itself to either superpower. The strong Indian left would have objected to alignment with